

Peter Prokunin

Indepentent backend architect / CTO / teamlead / coach

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Summary

Independent contractor specializing in backend and platform engineering, with deep experience in PHP (Symfony), Node.js (NestJS), system architecture, and technical leadership. Builds scalable, maintainable systems and establishes engineering practices that support long-term product growth.

Takes a pragmatic approach to AI, integrating AI capabilities where they deliver measurable business value and building AI-enabling infrastructure for production workflows. Experienced across AWS, Google Cloud, and bare-metal environments, selecting infrastructure based on technical and business constraints.

Proven track record delivering high-load systems and leading distributed teams across fintech, regtech, and e-commerce domains, including neo-banking and multi-integration platform projects.

Experience

Principal Developer, *NDA*

04/2024 – Present
United Kingdom

- Designed and developed core backend services for KYB/KYC, AML and payments processing workflows
- Worked on modeling and traversal of complex ownership and relationship structures using a custom graph-based engine
- Built and maintained public-facing APIs in NestJS layered above internal private APIs and core services implemented in Go
- Participated in architecture decisions around entity resolution, risk evaluation, onboarding orchestration and compliance automation
- Implemented scalable asynchronous workflows and event-driven communication between services
- Designed APIs and domain models for business entities, ownership hierarchies, verification states and compliance events
- Contributed to auditability, traceability and regulatory reporting capabilities required in regulated environments
- Worked closely with compliance, operations and product teams to translate regulatory requirements into platform capabilities
- Improved system reliability, observability and operational tooling for high-volume onboarding and verification flows
- Participated in technical leadership, architecture reviews and engineering standards definition across backend teams

Independent Contractor, *Freelance*

2019 – Present

- Design and deliver backend and platform solutions aligned with specific business and product requirements
- Projects include: neo-banking startup (B2B), e-gifting service with multiple integrations, other fin-tech, reg-tech and e-commerce projects

Development Team Leader, Silverbird • Led a cross-functional backend engineering team delivering integrations with payment providers, core banking banks and external financial services • Designed and evolved a modular integration architecture for PSP connectors, onboarding flows, KYC/eIDV providers and transaction processing • Built standardized connector framework reducing time-to-market for new providers and improving maintainability • Coordinated delivery across product, compliance and operations teams in highly regulated fintech environment • Implemented resilient asynchronous workflows using event-driven architecture and message brokers • Improved observability, failure recovery and reconciliation processes for payment flows • Participated in architecture decisions around PCI DSS, auditability, idempotency and transactional consistency • Mentored engineers, conducted technical planning, code reviews and incident management	07/2021 – 02/2024 United Kingdom
PHP Team Leader, TSUM • Managed a PHP development team and project backlog • Facilitated communication with clients and other development teams • Coordinated development and release processes • Worked closely with the DevOps team • Developed a system for efficient marketing campaign management based on large-scale event data	06/2018 – 12/2020 Moscow, Russia
PHP Team Lead, JivoChat • Acted as lead developer and owned system architecture • Managed the team across hiring, day-to-day management, and coaching	06/2017 – 07/2018 Moscow, Russia
Senior PHP Developer, Badoo • introduced internal tests statistic system • participated as sole developer in special project (Chappy)	01/2016 – 06/2017
CTO, Digital Society Laboratory • team management (10+) / hiring • system architecture • product description • project management	11/2014 – 12/2015 Moscow, Russia
CTO in Torg.mail.ru, Mail.Ru • Managing personnel (dev / UI / QA): 17 people • Managing infrastructure (> 40 dev/prod servers) • Managing application architecture • Strategic planning • Quality control processes • Project management • Implemented strategic planning for resources, projects, and needs • Achieved uptime > 99.99%	05/2013 – 08/2014 Moscow, Russia
Project Manager, Enter LLC • tracking & managing resources / deadlines / requirements • building project environment • communicating with internal customers and development team	03/2012 – 04/2013

Lead Developer, Enter LLC	01/2012 – 10/2012
• Team management • Release engineering	
Development Team Leader, Wikimart	08/2010 – 12/2011
• Software architecture development • Team management	
Developer, Wikimart	12/2009 – 12/2011
Developer, Fashiontime.ru	02/2009 – 05/2009

Education

MSc, Business Informatics, Higher School of Economics	2008 – 2010
Bachelor, Business Informatics, Higher School of Economics	2004 – 2008

Top Skills

• RabbitMQ	• Clouds
• NestJS	• PHP
• Symfony	• Team leadership
• PostgreSQL	• AI

Languages

Spanish	English	Russian
Elementary	Full Professional	Native or Bilingual

Publications

Key Skills (Freelance)

Business requirements analysis

System and architecture design

PHP / Node.js backend development

Technical project leadership

Team setup and mentoring

Highload / distributed / cloud systems

AI-enabling

Stakeholder communication